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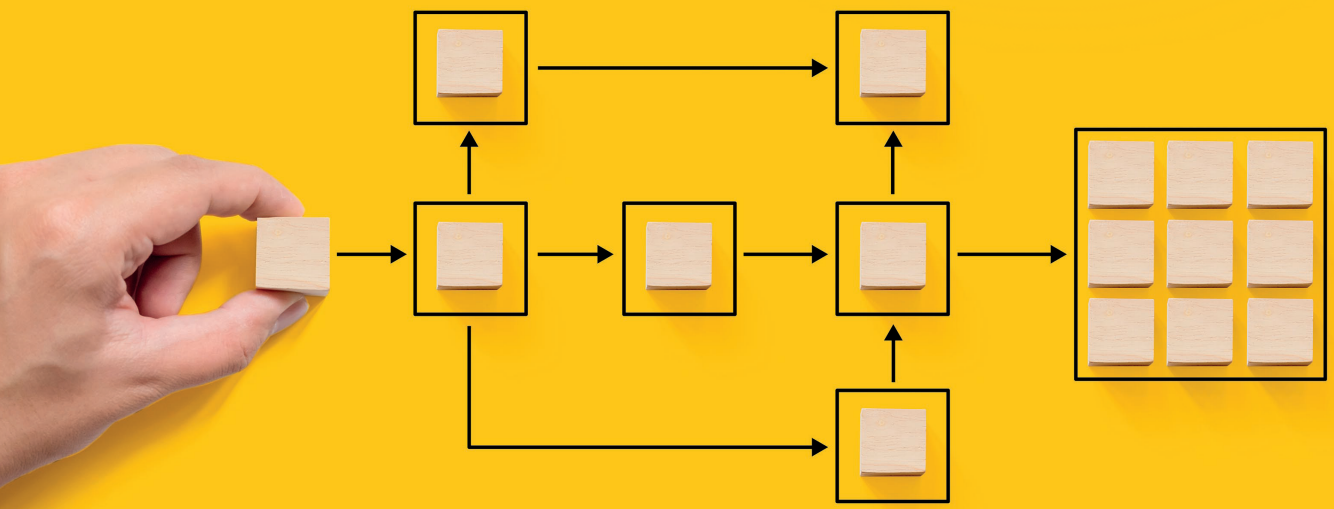
Developing and managing new PID Policy at the Tarki Social Science Data Archive



IMPLEMENTATION STORY

Authors names, affiliations and ORCIDs:

- Peter Hegedus, Head of Services, Tarki Social Science Data Archive, Hungary (sorry, I haven'ít got ORCHID number)

Editors

- Lassi Lager, CSC and FAIR-IMPACT (add ORCID)
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Summary:

The persistent identification of research outputs is part of good research data management practice and is central to the FAIR Principles and the vision of the European Open Science Cloud (EOSC). There are many types of persistent identifiers (PIDs) currently being used to identify data and other kinds of research outputs but also different actors involved in the creation of outputs and the organisations that employ them or fund their work. To foster harmonisation on the use of different persistent identifiers, there is a need to define and implement research data and/or PID policies. FAIR-IMPACT's Creating EOSC compliant Persistent Identifier (PID) policies support action[1] aimed to help successful applicants to complete self-assessments with regard to their PID policy readiness through the use of FAIRCORE4EOSC's Compliance Assessment Toolkit (CAT) service[2] which strives to encode, record, and query compliance with the EOSC PID policy. The support action did not focus on any specific PID type but rather provide general best practice guidelines on the creation and assessment of PID policies. This FAIR Implementation Story outlines the experience of Tarki Social Science Data archive, Hungary in relation to their self assessment.

1 https://fair-impact.eu/support-offer-2-creating-eosc-compliant-persistent-dentifier-pid-policies
2 https://faircore4eosc.eu/eosc-core-components/compliance-assessment-toolkit-cat

Approach taken:

During this support action, participants took part in three practical workshops and independently carried out a self-assessment of their PID policy readiness using FAIRCORE4EOSC's Compliance Assessment Tool (CAT).

How did you go about carrying out your self-assessment?

The Tarki Data Archive has worked with IDs for many years, but our ID system uses local internal own developed identifiers. We are at the beginning of the journey to create a developed up to date PID policy, this support action is our first step to plan what kind of work is before us. That's why we find all the assessment points useful. First, we have looked through the main categories of the self-assessment to see the fields that we have to work with. This ensured to look at the whole picture. After that we look through the points in the categories and can see the details of the requirements.

Did you need to consult with others in your organisation to carry out your self-assessment?

As a Head of Services, I also liaise with the organisation's IT developers and the database's data partners. Thus, for the current project, it was sufficient to collect the problems and needs that have arisen so far. Of course, regular communication will be necessary during the development, especially with the developers, but we will also ask for the partners' opinion during the audit.

Challenges encountered and addressed

Were there any policy areas for which you were not able to provide an answer? If so, why not? Any feedback on how to provide further possible clarification?

In general, in our organisation the technical documentations about our developments are not complete. This is because we have so far tried to find the simplest but most appropriate solutions. However, the program has helped us take it to the next level and develop a complete modern PID policy soon.

The other difficulty for us is creating legal documents. Our operation so far was actually based on an agreement between the database and the partners, which was formalised but did not go into full detail on certain elements. For example, point C13 on persistence services.

Were there any policy areas that you are not able to comply with? If so, why not? What should happen within this area in the near future?

For example, as a relatively small independent organisation, we often have problems proving our sustainability. It is difficult to provide evidence in this case. At the same time, there are areas that do not apply to our practice, such as the issue of sensitive metadata. We have designed our system in such a way that we do not need to have sensitive metadata.

But at the same time such a deficiency is for example the D17 kernel information profiles. In this case we will work with the developers to develop the necessary document

Impact

Did your participation in this support action provide you with a better understanding about what should be included in a PID policy?

Yes, the support action can show many aspects of creating and managing PID policy and can be a great example of our future developments.Yes. So far, we have received few indications that there is any problem with our current internal identifier system. However, we have noticed that some of our future developments will be hampered if we do not improve the existing system, but we have not been able to find a summary and sufficiently detailed guidance that would have been useful to us. This is why the current programme has been useful to us.

What do you see as the most crucial components to address within your own PID policy?

The most important thing for us is to be able to meet international requirements, together with keeping the advantages of the current system. Our current system includes many elements that our partners are used to and happy to use. One example is the use of the same reference to related materials within an identifier. It would be good to be able to combine the advantages of the current system and the new system.

In addition, we consider it important to maintain technical portability.

From our perspective the main advantage of the program is that we can learn about the detailed requirements about our developments to create a PID system and policy

Key messages

Are there any lessons that you learned that you would take forward as you refine or develop your PID policy? If so, what?

We are at the beginning of the journey to create a PID policy, this support action is our first step to plan what kind of work is before us. That's why we find all the assessment points and the others are useful.

Another lesson for us is that we also need to further develop our current options for PID policy and, if possible, to formalise the procedures for this even more.

To sum up, the most important thing for us was to see the challenges ahead as a whole. However, a particular lesson is that without knowing the details, it is difficult to see the whole picture.

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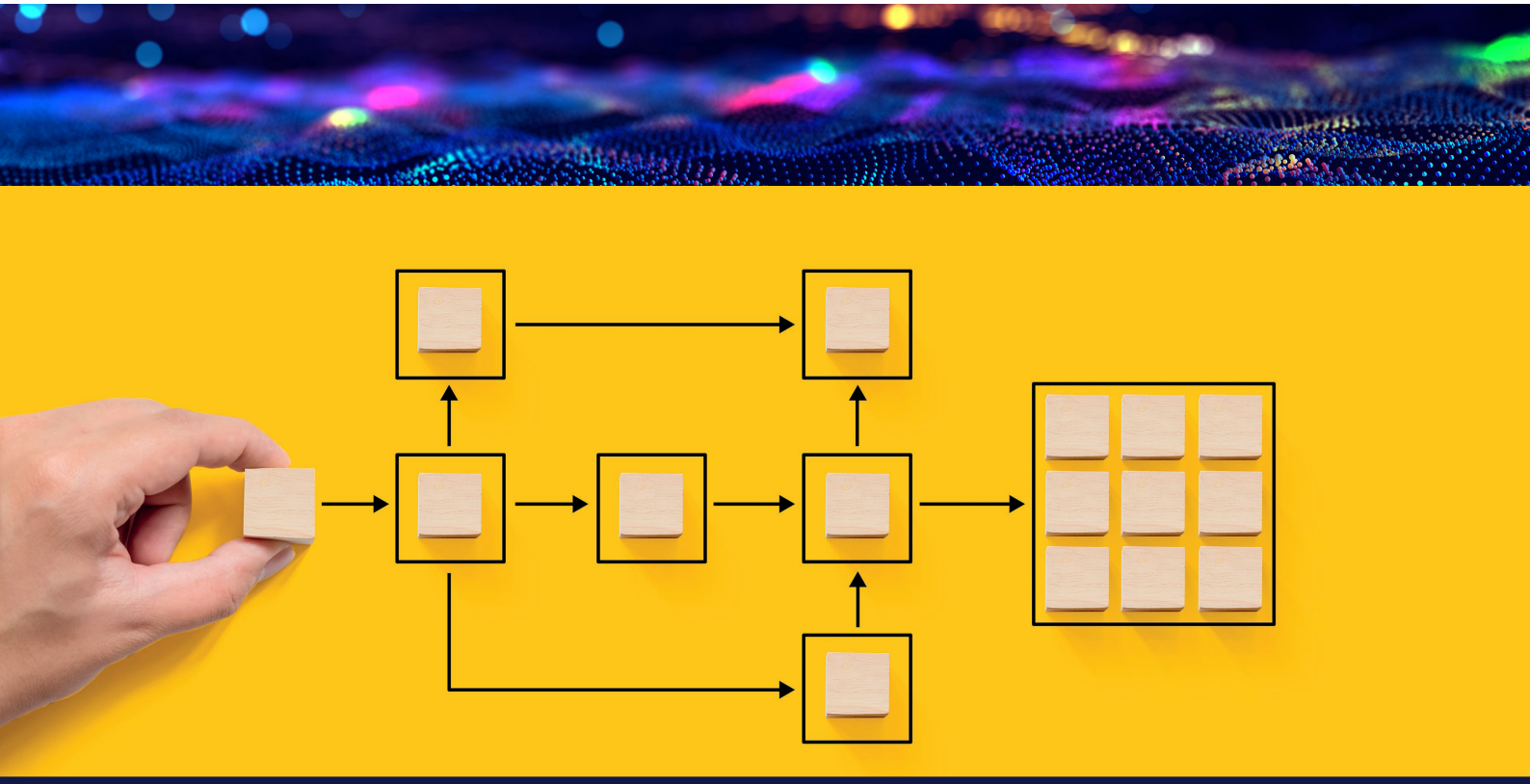

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